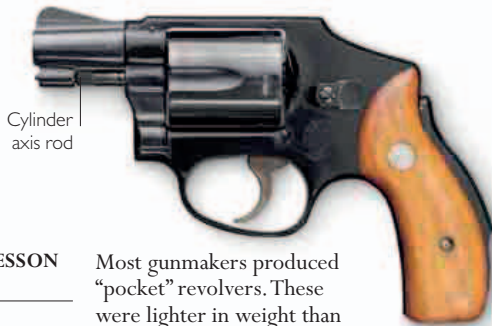


MODERN REVOLVERS

Despite the fact that their basic lock work was designed in the 19th century, revolvers remain extremely popular to this day. The reasons for this are their dependability, the ease with which they can be loaded, and their compact size. As self-defense weapons, their major assets are their light weight and the fact that they can be readily concealed. In addition, their construction allows them to use powerful cartridges that would place unacceptable strains on semiautomatic arms.

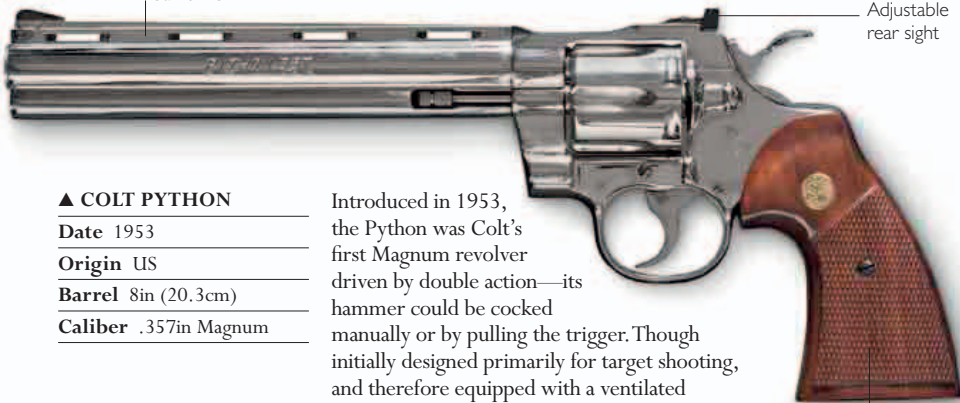


▲ SMITH AND WESSON
AIRWEIGHT

Date 1952
Origin US
Barrel 2in (5cm)
Caliber .38in Special

Most gunmakers produced “pocket” revolvers. These were lighter in weight than semiautomatic pistols chambered for the same ammunition, and to ensure easy concealment, they were fitted with an extremely short barrel. Smith and Wesson’s Centennial range, which included the Airweight, carried five rounds and had shrouded hammers. One version of the Airweight was made with an aluminum frame to reduce its weight.

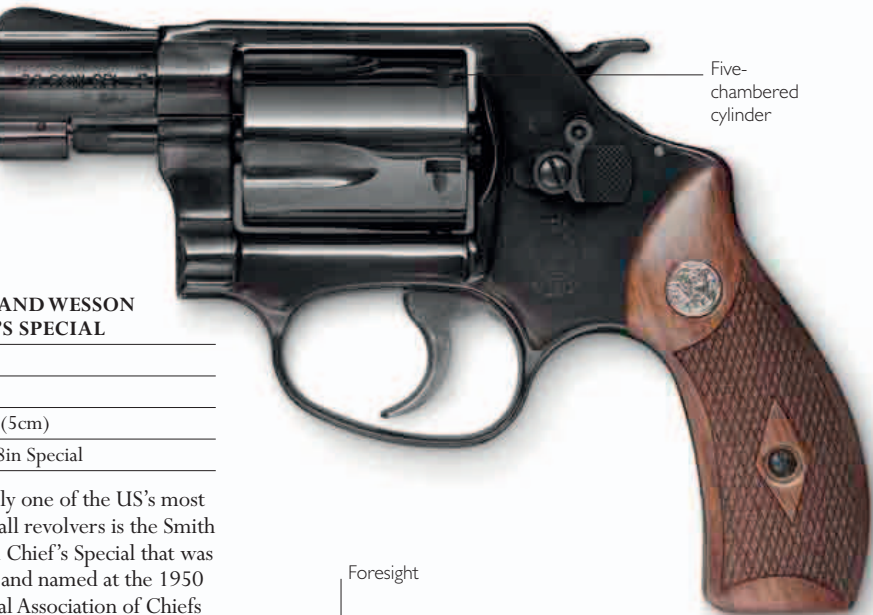
Ventilated
barrel rib



▲ COLT PYTHON

Date 1953
Origin US
Barrel 8in (20.3cm)
Caliber .357in Magnum

Introduced in 1953, the Python was Colt’s first Magnum revolver driven by double action—its hammer could be cocked manually or by pulling the trigger. Though initially designed primarily for target shooting, and therefore equipped with a ventilated sighting rib, the model was also made with short barrels to be issued to police.



► SMITH AND WESSON
.38 CHIEF'S SPECIAL

Date 1950
Origin US
Barrel 2in (5cm)
Caliber .38in Special

Undoubtedly one of the US’s most popular small revolvers is the Smith and Wesson Chief’s Special that was introduced and named at the 1950 International Association of Chiefs of Police Convention. Although its cylinder holds only five cartridges, rather than the more usual six, its small frame and short barrel makes it ideal for carrying in either a pocket or handbag.

Foresight

Model name
inscribed on barrel

Muzzle brake
diverts combustion
gases sideways to
reduce recoil



Adjustable
rear sight

Rear sight

Hammer

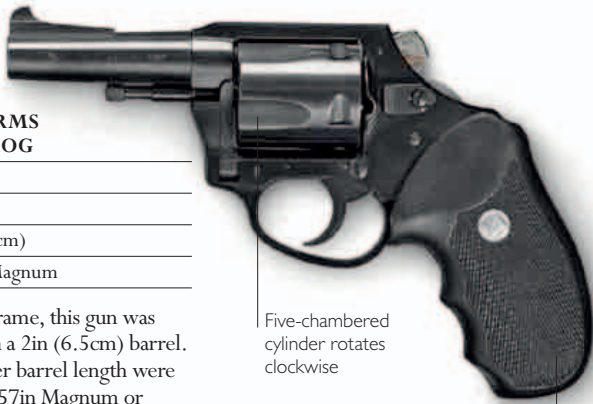
Checked
grip

Gold
inlays

► CHARTER ARMS
POLICE BULLDOG

Date 1971
Origin US
Barrel 4in (10.1cm)
Caliber .357in Magnum

Built on a heavy frame, this gun was also available with a 2in (6.5cm) barrel. Revolvers of either barrel length were chambered for .357in Magnum or .44in Special ammunition. The molded rubber grip reduced the amount of recoil transferred to the user’s hand.



Five-chambered
cylinder rotates
clockwise

Ergonomically designed
molded-rubber grip



Trigger
guard

Silver decoration
on grip